

news feed

DIGIT JUNE 2003

hypothesis

Athens PC

■ What is it?

The Athens PC is a prototype PC, which is considered by HP and Microsoft to be the future business desktop PC. With all communication media, including voice, video, and text converged.

■ How does it work?

Athens PC aims to shift from designing isolated hardware and software components to a whole system approach. It provides unified communication through integrated telephony and RTC (Real Time Communications). It includes integrated telephone, controls for telephony, convergence of a variety of telephony interfaces such as PSTN, PBX and cellular interfaces. The display is a high resolution, wide, 16:10 aspect ratio flat panel.

■ What does it do?

Athens PC switches between on and standby mode in less than 2 seconds, thus you don't wait for the PC to boot up every time. In case of power failures, the PC goes into a hibernate mode, saving important data. Controls on the keyboard are organised in logical groups, including media transport, system-wide volume and mute, notification and telephone controls. The integrated telephony has physical buttons and displays, so that the phone features can be seen and used without turning on the computer. It features high-quality audio and operates silently.

A grid effort

A new initiative has been taken by D2OL (Drug Design and Optimization Lab), to test drugs that might help to cure SARS. The project uses a computer's idle time to create a supercomputer capable of testing the effectiveness of potential drugs. Around 15,000 computer users have downloaded the project software.

Grid computing can screen potential drugs much faster than laboratorial researchers. They are used to analyse different compounds as candidates for the suitable drug. After the compounds are pinpointed, they are ranked in order of how likely they are to work, and then tested in that order.

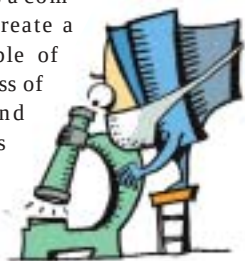
The American Diabetic Association has also signed

Gateway for its grid computing Service. The ADA will use 'Gateway's Processing On Demand' solution, backed by United Device's Grid MP

Alliance platform, to accelerate diabetes research. The platform with 7,000 computers will run software to help the ADA analyse clinical programs and

treatments, develop clinical practice guidelines, study the efficiency of care processes, set priorities and plan its research.

The Gateway Grid can produce more than 11 TFLOPS (trillion floating point operations per second) at peak capacity.



ILLUSTRATIONS: Farzana Cooper

Crystal ball monitor

The Perspecta 3D System is a 360-degree spatial display, powered by the Perspecta platform and application software. In this system, the screen is a rotating disk that is capable of producing light at any point it passes through. The result is a real 3D representation of the object, which can be viewed from any angle, without the need for any special goggles. The display illuminates 100

million volume pixels, or 'voxels', using Actuality's patented technologies, within a transparent Lexan dome.



Recently, Actuality Systems announced its first European sale to ENEA, the Italian National Agency for New Technologies. The Perspecta 3D System will be used as part of the centre's applied research and development work in 3D imaging of scientific data.

Karnataka signs MoU with IBM

The Karnataka government and IBM signed a Memorandum of Understanding on 9th May, to advance e-learning initiatives based on Open Source technology. IBM will work with BITES (Board of IT education Standards) and IIT, Hubli, to develop an e-learning platform and to develop IBM centre of Excellence, which will be devoted to open source software.

Steve Hills, Senior Vice President, IBM, said that with this, IBM would leverage local talent and bring existing syllabus, faculty and students on par with the IT emerging technologies. The e-learning portal will entail content, faculty training, mentoring of students and application developments. The courseware will be based on Linux and Eclipse OSS (Open Source Software) and work on the development of technologies, such as Middleware Components, Device Drivers, and Real Time Applications etc.

snapshot

30,674,408
The total
number of .com,
.edu, .net,
.org and .co.uk
domain names
worldwide:

Source: Domainstats.com



■ NEC launched the MobilePro 900—a Windows CE 3.0-based device is aimed at the enterprise ■ Windows XP 64-bit Edition will require a minimum of 1GB of memory